

ALL-IN · CHAMATH, SACKS, FRIEDBERG & CALACANIS

E184: Rate Cuts, AI Capex, and the IPO Window Reopens

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1H 22M

4 HIGHLIGHTS

2 QUESTIONS

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01 AI Summary

The panel splits on the central question of the moment: **is hyperscaler AI capex a rational supercycle or a late-stage bubble?** The bull case leans on real revenue and the power-constraint thesis; the bear case points to **circular financing** and depreciation schedules that may be wildly optimistic.

There's consensus on one thing: **a reopening IPO window changes venture math**. Several late-stage names finally have a clearing price, which pulls forward distributions and resets the bar for what stays private. The group debates whether this is healthy price discovery or a liquidity-driven head-fake.

02 Investable Insight

— WHAT CHANGED

The AI-capex debate moved from "is demand real?" to "what depreciation schedule are hyperscalers actually using?" — the panel reframed the bull/bear split as an accounting assumption, and a reopening IPO window gave late-stage names a clearing price for the first time in two years.

— WHY IT MATTERS

If GPUs are 3-year assets rather than 6, much of the reported AI-infrastructure margin is fiction — so the same revenue supports either a supercycle or a bubble. The IPO reopening pulls venture distributions forward and resets how long companies rationally stay private.

— WHO BENEFITS

- ◆ **Nvidia (NVDA)** — real, power-constrained end-demand and durable infra margins if the 6-year GPU life holds
- ◆ **Late-stage venture / LPs** — a credible IPO path pulls distributions forward after a two-year freeze

— WHO'S AT RISK

- ◆ **Most-levered AI names** — circular, vendor-funded demand flatters the real end-market and unwinds if financing tightens
- ◆ **Holders assuming 6-year depreciation** — a shift to a 3-year schedule guts reported margins

— DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

What depreciation schedule are the top hyperscalers actually using for GPUs, and how would a 3-year assumption change reported cloud margins?

How much of this quarter's AI revenue is vendor-financed versus organic end-demand?

Which late-stage names have a genuine clearing price now, versus a liquidity-driven head-fake?

03 Key Numbers

METRIC	VALUE	CONTEXT
GPU useful life (bull vs bear)	6 years vs 3 years	The swing assumption behind AI-infra margins
Fed cuts expected in 2026	2 more	Chamath's macro call on disinflation + easing conditions

04 Ideas Pitched

STOCK Long Nvidia (NVDA) into the capex supercycle

Pitched by **David Sacks**

- ◆ End-demand is real and **power-constrained**, not vendor-manufactured
- ◆ A 6-year useful life on GPUs keeps infra margins durable, not fictional
- ◆ Every hyperscaler is still guiding capex up, not down

STOCK Buy the clean AI-infrastructure IPOs as the window reopens

Pitched by **Jason Calacanis**

- ◆ A few clean listings have reset comps and proven there's a clearing price
- ◆ Late-stage names finally have liquidity, pulling venture distributions forward

TRADE Fade the most levered AI names on circular financing

Pitched by **David Friedberg**

- ◆ When the chip vendor funds the cloud that buys its chips, reported demand is flattered
- ◆ If GPUs depreciate over 3 years instead of 6, much of the reported margin is fiction

MACRO The Fed cuts twice more in 2026

Pitched by **Chamath Palihapitiya**

- ◆ Disinflation is back on trend and the labor market is softening at the edges
- ◆ A reopening IPO window is itself evidence that financial conditions are easing

05 Highlights

22:15 ◆ The depreciation argument

Whether AI infra margins are real comes down to one accounting assumption: if GPUs are 6-year assets the math works; if they're 3-year assets, much of the reported margin is fiction.

49:30 ◆ Circular financing is the risk to watch

When the chip vendor funds the cloud that buys the chips, reported demand can flatter the real end-market — Friedberg's red flag for separating real from vendor-funded demand.

1:02:10 ◆ The IPO window is genuinely open

A handful of clean listings reset comps and pull venture distributions forward for the first time in two years.

1:10:45

What reopening markets change for founders

Late-stage secondaries and a credible IPO path reset how long a company would rationally stay private.

06 Q&A

Q Is this a bubble?

Sacks says no — the revenue is real and power-constrained. Friedberg is more cautious, flagging depreciation and vendor financing as the tells to watch.

Q What reopens for founders?

Late-stage secondary and a credible IPO path, which changes how long you'd rationally stay private.
